

D359

Agile HR

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

An HR team at a 3,000-person logistics firm spent eight months writing a detailed annual engagement plan. Midway through the year, a merger changed the workforce and several planned programs no longer fit. The team's director holds two HR certifications. Following agile values, what should the team do?

- A. Stop planning entirely, since agile teams do not plan.
- B. Freeze all programs until the merger is fully complete, then write a new annual plan.
- C. Re-plan in short cycles around the new workforce's needs.
- D. Finish the original plan because leadership already approved it.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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2.

An HR team runs two-week sprints to build a new onboarding program. At the end of a sprint, the team meets on its own to discuss how its handoffs and meetings went and what to change about how it works next sprint. The sprint delivered three of four planned items, and the team uses a digital board. Which Scrum event is this?

- A. Daily scrum
- B. Sprint retrospective
- C. Sprint review
- D. Sprint review, because one item was not delivered

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

At the end of a sprint, an HR team wants to show its new onboarding portal to hiring managers and collect their feedback on it. Which Scrum event fits?

- A. Sprint review
- B. Sprint retrospective
- C. Daily scrum
- D. None; agile teams never show unfinished work

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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4.

An HR team wants to redesign its parental leave process. The benefits budget grew 5% this year, and the team has a new HRIS. The team lead proposes jumping straight to building a new leave portal. Following design thinking, what should come first?

- A. Interview and observe employees who have used the leave process to understand their needs.
- B. Build a prototype of the portal and test it.
- C. Run a brainstorming workshop on solutions.
- D. Configure the leave module in the new HRIS.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

An HR team plans a peer-recognition program for a 12,000-employee retailer. It has already interviewed employees and has a clear problem statement. The CEO likes the idea and the team has a \$200,000 budget. Using an agile approach, what is the best next step?

- A. Pilot only after the design is perfect.
- B. Spend the budget on an enterprise platform first, since the CEO supports it.
- C. Launch a simple version in a few stores, measure use, and improve it in short cycles.
- D. Build the full program and launch it to all stores at once.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A recruiting team's Kanban board shows 30 open requisitions in progress on average. The team closes 10 requisitions per week. The board uses five columns and is color-coded by department. On average, how long does a requisition take from start to finish?

- A. 3 weeks
- B. One-third of a week
- C. 10 weeks
- D. 5 weeks

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team keeps 16 items in progress and wants an average cycle time of 2 weeks. What throughput must it achieve?

- A.** 32 items per week
- B.** 8 items per week
- C.** Any throughput works; WIP alone sets cycle time
- D.** 16 items per week

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

An HR team has capacity for one initiative. A: cost of delay 20, job size 10. B: cost of delay 12, job size 3. C: cost of delay 24, job size 12. D: cost of delay 2, job size 1. Option A is sponsored by the COO. Using weighted shortest job first, which goes first?

- A.** D, because the smallest job always goes first
- B.** A
- C.** B
- D.** C

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An initiative has a job size of 5 and must reach a WSJF score of at least 3 to be funded. What minimum cost-of-delay score does it need?

- A.** 0.6
- B.** 8
- C.** 5
- D.** 15

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A company is moving managers to a new continuous-feedback tool. Surveys show managers understand why the change is happening and want it to succeed, but many do not know how to give feedback in the tool. The rollout cost \$85,000 and the vendor is based in Austin. Using ADKAR, where is the barrier?

- A.** Reinforcement, which is always the hardest stage.
- B.** Awareness; send more messages explaining why.
- C.** Desire; add incentives for using the tool.
- D.** Knowledge; provide training and coaching on how to use the tool.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Employees perform a new process well in training but slide back to old habits within a month. Which ADKAR element is weakest?

- A.** Ability
- B.** Reinforcement
- C.** Knowledge
- D.** Awareness

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An HR team at a clinic chain, which opened four new sites this year, sets the objective ‘Make onboarding something new hires rave about.’ Which is the best key result for this objective?

- A.** Launch a new onboarding video.
- B.** Improve onboarding a lot.
- C.** Hold onboarding sessions at all four new sites.
- D.** Raise new-hire 30-day satisfaction from 68% to 85% by the end of Q3.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

An HR team ~~at a 3,000-person logistics firm~~ spent eight months writing a detailed annual engagement plan. Midway through the year, a merger changed the workforce and several planned programs no longer fit. ~~The team's director holds two HR certifications.~~ Following agile values, what should the team do?

Target word: response to changed conditions **Decides:** The plan no longer fits the workforce after the merger.

A	Absolute language	Agile teams plan often, in short increments.
B	Adjacent category	That is a waterfall phase gate, not iterative delivery.
C	Correct	Agile values responding to change over following a plan.
D	Inverted operation	Puts following the plan ahead of responding to change.

2. Answer B Concept 2

An HR team runs two-week sprints to build a new onboarding program. At the end of a sprint, the team meets on its own to discuss how its handoffs and meetings went and what to change about how it works next sprint. ~~The sprint delivered three of four planned items, and the team uses a digital board.~~ Which Scrum event is this?

Target word: name the event **Decides:** The team reviews its own way of working, without stakeholders.

A	Adjacent category	A short daily sync on progress, not an end-of-sprint process review.
B	Correct	The retrospective inspects the team's process and plans improvements.
C	Confusion set	The review shows the product to stakeholders for feedback.
D	Camouflage	The missed item does not change which event this is.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

At the end of a sprint, an HR team wants to show its new onboarding portal to hiring managers and collect their feedback on it. Which Scrum event fits?

Target word: event for showing the product **Decides:** Stakeholders inspect the product.

A	Correct	The review demonstrates the increment to stakeholders and gathers feedback.
B	Inverted operation	The retrospective looks inward at the team's process, not outward at the product.
C	Adjacent category	A team-only daily check-in.
D	Absolute language	Showing work often is the point of the review.

4. Answer A Concept 3

An HR team wants to redesign its parental leave process. ~~The benefits budget grew 5% this year, and the team has a new HRIS.~~ The team lead proposes jumping straight to building a new leave portal. Following design thinking, what should come first?

Target word: first step **Decides:** Design thinking begins with empathy for users.

A	Correct	Empathize is the first stage.
B	Inverted operation	Prototyping comes after empathizing, defining and ideating.
C	Confusion set	Ideation comes after the problem is understood and defined.
D	Camouflage	Answers the HRIS detail; a tool is a solution, not a first step.

5. Answer C Concept 4

An HR team plans a peer-recognition program for a 12,000-employee retailer. It has already interviewed employees and has a clear problem statement. ~~The CEO likes the idea and the team has a \$200,000 budget.~~ Using an agile approach, what is the best next step?

Target word: rollout approach **Decides:** Agile tests a small version with real users first.

A	Absolute language	An MVP is released before it is perfect so users can shape it.
B	Camouflage	Sponsorship and budget do not decide the rollout method.
C	Correct	A minimum viable pilot gives fast, real feedback.
D	Inverted operation	Big-bang launch is the opposite of iterative delivery.

6. Answer A Concept 5

A recruiting team's Kanban board shows 30 open requisitions in progress on average. The team closes 10 requisitions per week. ~~The board uses five columns and is color-coded by department.~~ On average, how long does a requisition take from start to finish?

Target word: average cycle time **Decides:** Cycle time = WIP ÷ throughput.

A	Correct	$30 \div 10$ per week = 3 weeks.
B	Inverted operation	Divides throughput by WIP.
C	Wrong stem number	The weekly throughput, not the cycle time.
D	Camouflage	The number of board columns, which does not set cycle time.

7. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A team keeps 16 items in progress and wants an average cycle time of 2 weeks. What throughput must it achieve?

Target word: solve for throughput **Decides:** Throughput = WIP ÷ cycle time.

A	Inverted operation	Multiplies WIP by cycle time.
B	Correct	$16 \div 2 = 8$ per week.
C	Absolute language	Cycle time depends on both WIP and throughput.
D	Wrong stem number	The WIP count, not the throughput.

8. Answer C Concept 6

An HR team has capacity for one initiative. A: cost of delay 20, job size 10. B: cost of delay 12, job size 3. C: cost of delay 24, job size 12. D: cost of delay 2, job size 1. ~~Option A is sponsored by the COO.~~ Using weighted shortest job first, which goes first?

Target word: highest WSJF **Decides:** WSJF = cost of delay ÷ job size: A 2, B 4, C 2, D 2.

A	Absolute language	Size alone does not decide; D scores only 2.
B	Camouflage	COO sponsorship does not enter WSJF; A scores 2.
C	Correct	$12 \div 3 = 4$, the highest score.
D	Dropped element	Highest cost of delay, but ignores job size (score 2).

9. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

An initiative has a job size of 5 and must reach a WSJF score of at least 3 to be funded. What minimum cost-of-delay score does it need?

Target word: solve for cost of delay **Decides:** Cost of delay = WSJF × job size.

A	Inverted operation	Divides 3 by 5 instead of multiplying.
B	Inverted operation	Adds the two numbers instead of multiplying.
C	Wrong stem number	The job size, not the cost of delay.
D	Correct	$3 \times 5 = 15$.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A company is moving managers to a new continuous-feedback tool. Surveys show managers understand why the change is happening and want it to succeed, but many do not know how to give feedback in the tool. ~~The rollout cost \$85,000 and the vendor is based in Austin.~~ Using ADKAR, where is the barrier?

Target word: first missing ADKAR element **Decides:** Awareness and desire are present; know-how is missing.

A	Absolute language	The barrier is the first missing element, here knowledge.
B	Confusion set	Surveys show they already understand why.
C	Adjacent category	They already want it to succeed.
D	Correct	They know why and want it, but not how.

11. Answer B Concept 7 • transfer

Employees perform a new process well in training but slide back to old habits within a month. Which ADKAR element is weakest?

Target word: missing element from the symptom **Decides:** They can do it but it does not stick.

A	Adjacent category	They demonstrated they can do it.
B	Correct	Sliding back after success means the change is not being sustained.
C	Confusion set	They performed well in training, so they know how.
D	Inverted operation	Awareness is the first element; the problem is at the end of the sequence.

12. Answer D Concept 8

An HR team at a clinic chain, ~~which opened four new sites this year,~~ sets the objective 'Make onboarding something new hires rave about.' Which is the best key result for this objective?

Target word: well-formed key result **Decides:** A measurable outcome with a baseline, target and date.

A	Adjacent category	A task or output, not a result.
B	Dropped element	No measure, baseline or date.
C	Camouflage	An activity built on the new-sites detail, not an outcome.
D	Correct	Measurable outcome tied to the objective.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Agile values applied to HR	Value responding to change over following a plan and people over process, while still planning in short cycles.	Finishing an outdated plan because it was approved, or thinking agile means no planning.	Conditions change midway through a long plan.
2	Sprint review vs. sprint retrospective	The review inspects the product with stakeholders; the retrospective is the team inspecting how it works.	Calling any end-of-sprint meeting a review.	Is the meeting about the thing built or about the team's process?
3	Design thinking starts with empathy	Design thinking runs empathize, define, ideate, prototype, test; start by understanding the people who use the process.	Jumping to a solution or tool before understanding users.	A team eager to build before talking to employees.
4	Minimum viable product and piloting	Release the smallest useful version to real users, measure, and improve in short cycles.	Launching the full program company-wide at once, or waiting for perfection.	A large rollout with a clear problem statement and a budget.
5	Kanban flow and Little's Law	Average cycle time = work in progress ÷ throughput; limiting WIP shortens cycle time.	Multiplying WIP by throughput, or ignoring WIP.	Items in progress and items finished per week in one stem.
6	Weighted shortest job first	WSJF = cost of delay ÷ job size; do the highest score first.	Picking the biggest cost of delay, the smallest job, or the best-sponsored item.	A list of options with cost-of-delay and size scores.
7	ADKAR change model	Change moves through Awareness, Desire, Knowledge, Ability, Reinforcement; fix the first element that is missing.	Answering every change barrier with more communication.	People understand and want the change but still struggle, or slide back.
8	OKRs	The objective is qualitative and inspiring; each key result is a measurable outcome with a target and date.	Writing activities or vague aims as key results.	Choose the best key result for a stated objective.

Course scope (public description): Agility has become a defining characteristic of successful organizations, and HR is no exception. This course introduces you to agile approaches that make HR more flexible, people-centered, and responsive to change. You will explore design thinking, change management, and strategic prioritization, building skills that position you as an HR professional ready to help organizations thrive in dynamic environments.